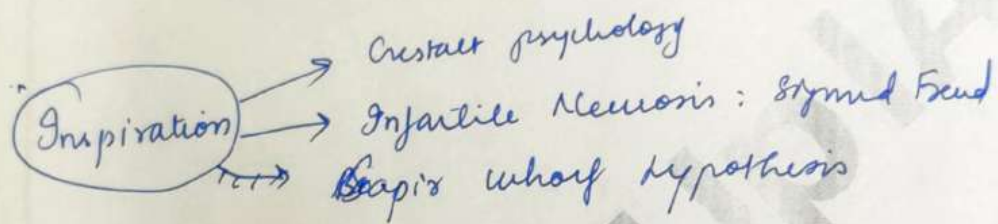


Q.7a (20 marks): What is cognitive anthropology? Highlight contribution of scholars

Q8. (a) What are the key principles of cognitive anthropology? Also highlight the contribution of its scholars. (20 marks)

Cognitive Anthropology as a school of thought emerged to understand relation between human thought and culture (Andrade).



Basic Concepts:

- 1) Culture is an ideation system existing in human minds as perception of the material world around them. and 1
- 2) Culture is a universal cognitive process whose structure is reflected in human mind as cognitive structures.
- 3) Thus to understand culture one needs to understand beyond the surface of human behaviour & deconstruct their minds.

4) The school developed in 3 phases :

(i) As Ethnoscience: Use of language heavily.

Goodenough's componential analysis: Just like language categories, human thought ~~sets~~ also categorises everything around them into domains & one has to do componential analysis of these domain to understand classificatory structures of human brain.

(ii) Study of Folk Taxonomies:

A) Hanunoo Color Categories: Harold Conklin

Studies how division of colors among Hanunoo are not similar to the American classes as they add an additional component of wetness/dryness. Thus human thought varies in its classifications.

B) Stephen Tylor : "A study of Koya grammar
shows how Koyas have different conceptions
of writing than Americans.
He also shows how in American society
cousins is a term for all maternal
and paternal relatives. Specific cultures
have diff taxonomies based on the
relation's significance to them.

(iii) Schema Theory & Consensus theory :
moving beyond layman's basis to
psychological basis where schemas are
the psychological constructs based on experiences.

Consensus theory says that the Information
varies among different participants and
hence multiple interviews need to
be taken.

Criticism

- 1) Keering says that there are extremely subjective in nature & no definite methodology.
- 2) The cognitive theorists have been criticised for picking up on irrelevant taxonomies without understand cultural processes.
- 3) Universal Marxists criticise them for ~~overemphasising~~ neglect of social realities.
- 4) Post modernists say that there can't be objective nature of the work.

~~Relevance~~

The school & its theories are ever more relevant when in the age of Artificial Intelligence which models the human brain neurons.